The Landscape of Chinese Overseas Renewable Energy Projects — Q3 2026

Bingcai Liu, Wei Shen, Zhengyun Zhou

October 2026

International Institute of Green Finance (IIGF)
Institute of Development Studies (IDS)





About this Publication

Marking an expansion in our tracking scope, this quarterly D-CORE update incorporates transmission and distribution and new energy manufacturing alongside renewable generation and storage projects for the first time, reviewing Chinese participation across 170 projects and 175 project events from July to September 2026. The findings are those of the authors and do not necessarily represent the views of IIGF or IDS.

Scope and Statistical Approach

The report draws on D-CORE data through 30 September 2026. Projects with a recorded milestone during the quarter are counted once, including those signed, under construction, or in operation. Generation capacity refers to the latest disclosed installed capacity for these projects by the quarter end. Comparisons with Q3 2025 and Q2 2026 use the same September dataset and classification.

Expansion of Tracking Scope (New in Q3 2026). Starting with this Q3 2026 edition, D-CORE has officially expanded its tracking and analytical scope beyond power generation and storage to include transmission and distribution as well as new energy manufacturing. Prior quarterly updates (Q1 and Q2 2026) focused exclusively on generation and storage assets. To ensure consistent, rigorous comparative analysis, we retrospectively compiled and standardized historical project activities in transmission and manufacturing under the same analytical framework. Moving forward, D-CORE will maintain this expanded multi-segment coverage in subsequent quarterly reports, providing a comprehensive view of China's overseas energy engagement across power generation, grid infrastructure, and industrial supply chains.

Solar-plus-storage and wind-plus-storage projects are classified under Solar PV and Wind Power, respectively; standalone storage forms the Energy Storage category. Generation MW and battery MWh are reported separately. Manufacturing and transmission are presented by project count. Financing information is available for five of the 113 generation and storage projects; financing is therefore discussed through the case studies.

Key Findings

- **Overseas activity broadened across the energy sector.** Reflecting the inclusion of transmission and manufacturing in our statistical scope from this quarter onward, the D-CORE portfolio captured 170 projects, up from 163 in Q3 2025 and 132 in Q2 2026 under the same harmonized scope. Generation and storage accounted for 113 projects, transmission for 34, and manufacturing for 23.
- **The divergence between project count and capacity is obvious in Q3.** Generation and storage project count rose 11% quarter-on-quarter to 113, but associated generation capacity fell to 19.8 GW, from 35.0 GW in Q2 2026 and 41.2 GW a year earlier. This mainly reflected a more dispersed project mix and the absence of large investment clusters in Q3.
- **Solar PV is still the leading technology, but storage continued to mainstream.** Solar accounted for 46 projects. Standalone storage projects increased from 22 to 27 YoY.

Generation projects with storage rose from 12 to 18. This confirms that storage is increasingly embedded across the portfolio, rather than remaining a niche category.

- **Manufacturing activity nearly doubled year on year.** The quarter covered 23 projects, compared with 12 in Q3 2025. Egypt hosted four projects, followed by Malaysia and Spain with three each.
- **Chinese participation combined engineering and equipment supply.** EPC contractors and equipment suppliers each accounted for 38 recorded participation relationships. PowerChina led by project count, alongside prominent wind, solar and battery manufacturers.

Technological Composition

Solar PV accounted for 46 projects in Q3 2026, or 41% of the total generation and storage. Activity rose from 34 projects in the previous quarter but remained below the 58 recorded a year earlier. Wind power reached 27 projects, up from 24 in Q3 2025 and 17 in Q2 2026. Standalone storage also accounted for 27 projects, giving wind and storage a combined share of 48%.

Generation and storage activity totaled 113 projects, up 11% from Q2 2026 and down 15% YoY. Associated generation capacity reached 19.8 GW, down from 35.0 GW in Q2 and 41.2 GW a year earlier. The smaller total capacity reflected a shift in the technology mix: hydropower fell from 15 to four projects and integrated energy from nine to three, while wind and standalone storage expanded. Biomass accounted for four projects and geothermal and waste heat for two.

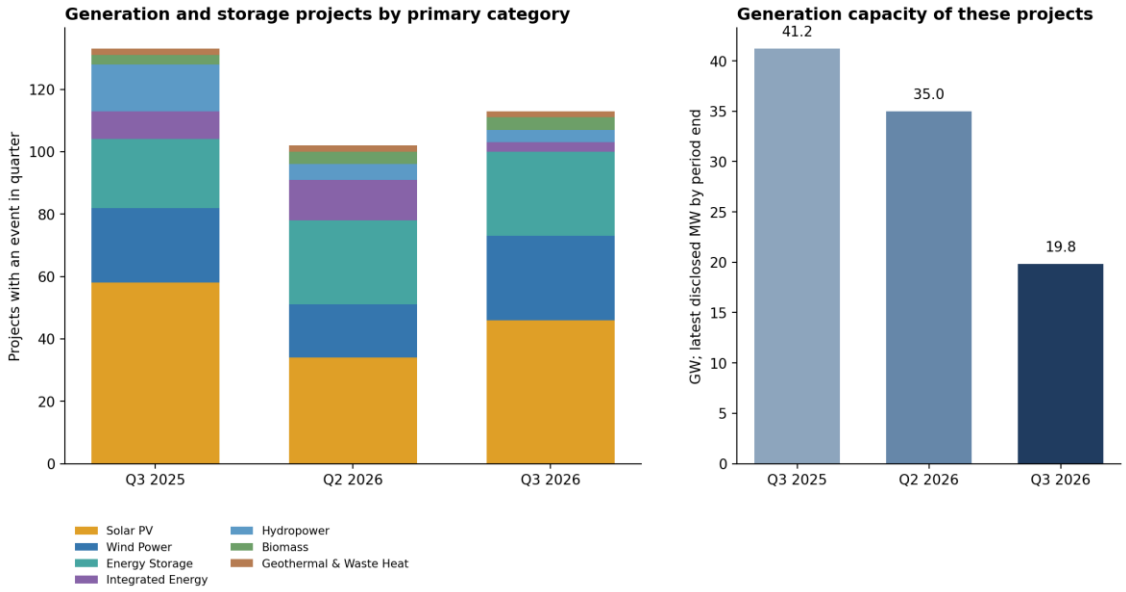


Figure 1. Generation and storage projects by technology, and associated generation capacity, Q3 2025, Q2 2026 and Q3 2026.

Storage activity increased in both project groups. Standalone storage grew by 23% year on year, from 22 to 27 projects, while generation projects with storage grew by 50%, from 12 to 18. Together, these groups comprised 45 projects, up from 34 a year earlier. Their combined share

of generation and storage activity rose from 26% to 40%, underscoring storage's growing role in the overseas project portfolio.

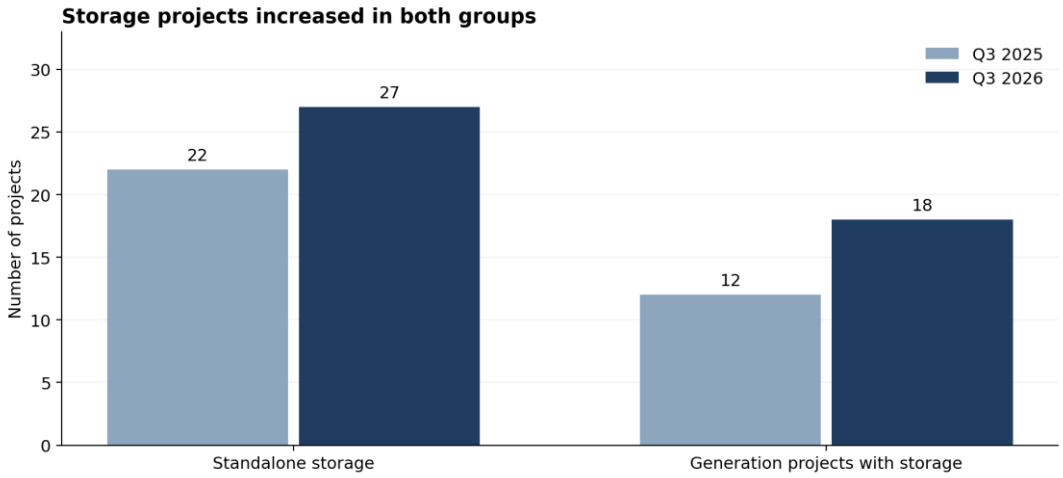


Figure 2. Standalone storage and generation projects incorporating storage, Q3 2025 and Q3 2026.

Geographic Distribution

South-eastern Asia led in project count, with 22 generation and storage projects, followed by Central Asia (15), Southern Europe (14), and Western Asia (12). Central Asia led in generation capacity at 5.0 GW. South-eastern Asia accounted for 3.6 GW, Western Asia for 3.0 GW, and Northern Africa for 2.9 GW across four projects. These patterns show a broad base of activity in South-eastern Asia and larger individual developments in Central Asia and Northern Africa.

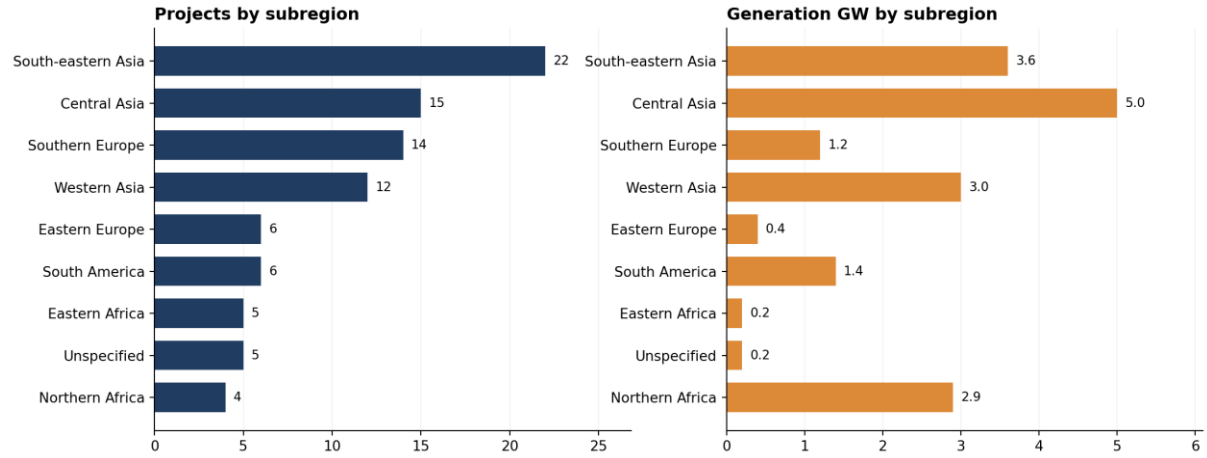


Figure 3. Generation and storage project counts and associated generation capacity by subregion, Q3 2026.

Cambodia recorded the most projects at country level, with eight, followed by Serbia with seven. Uzbekistan, Kazakhstan and Türkiye each recorded six. Egypt led in generation capacity with 2.75 GW, followed by Kazakhstan (2.68 GW) and Saudi Arabia (2.50 GW). Egypt's total included the Minya and Abydos II solar projects, while Saudi Arabia's included the 2 GW Furais solar

project. Together, these three countries accounted for 40% of the quarter's associated generation capacity.

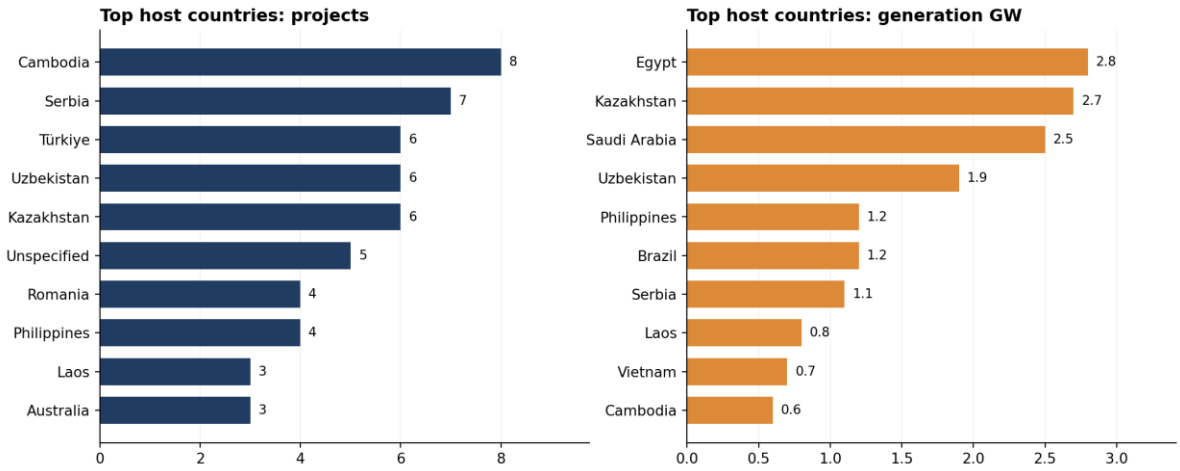


Figure 4. Leading host countries by generation and storage project count and associated generation capacity, Q3 2026.

Least Developed Countries and Other Markets

Least Developed Countries (LDCs) hosted 20 generation and storage projects in Q3 2026, while non-LDC markets hosted 88. Solar PV accounted for 12 of the LDC projects (60%), followed by biomass (3), wind and standalone storage (2 each), and hydropower (1). Non-LDC markets had a more varied technology mix, with 33 solar projects, 25 wind projects, and 21 standalone storage projects.

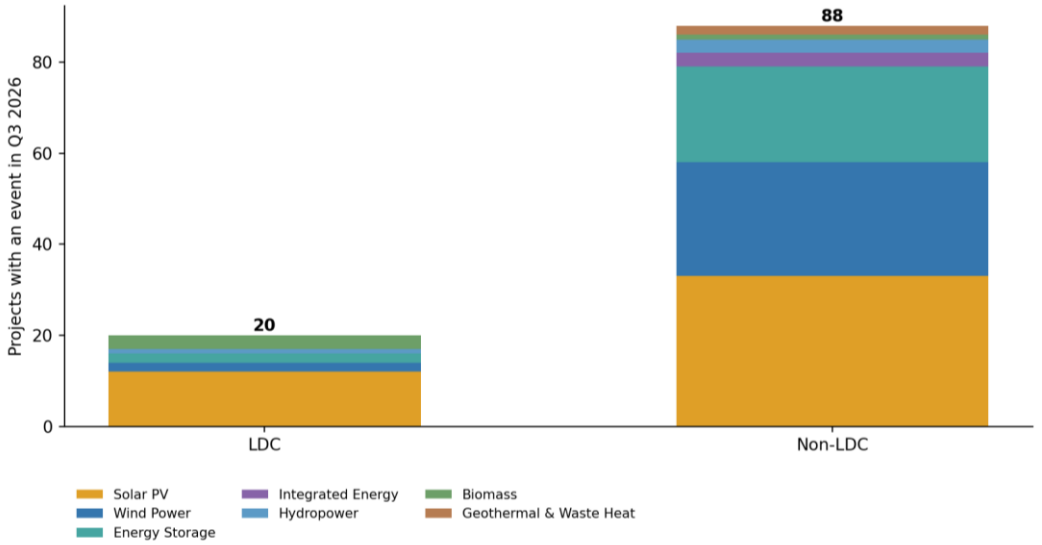


Figure 5. Generation and storage projects by technology in LDC and non-LDC markets, Q3 2026. Five projects with unspecified locations are excluded.

Solar remained the main focus of Chinese renewable energy participation in LDC markets. The presence of standalone storage in two LDC projects also shows that battery deployment is

extending into less-developed markets, creating opportunities to apply storage alongside the expansion of renewable power. The broader mix in non-LDC markets included substantial activity in both wind and dedicated storage.

New Energy Manufacturing and Transmission

New energy manufacturing accounted for 23 projects in Q3 2026, up from 12 a year earlier and seven in Q2 2026. The quarter saw 22 new projects. Egypt hosted four projects, followed by Malaysia and Spain with three each. The increase expands Chinese firms' overseas presence from power project delivery to the manufacture of batteries, materials, and renewable energy equipment.

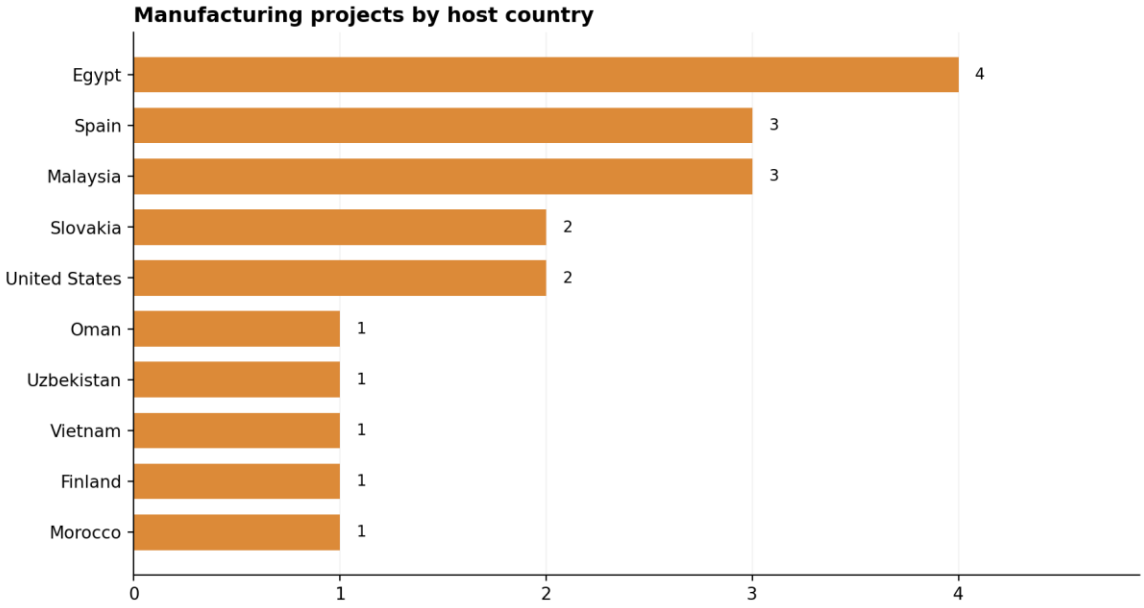


Figure 6. New energy manufacturing projects by host country, Q3 2026.

Transmission and distribution accounted for a further 34 projects, compared with 18 in Q3 2025 and 23 in Q2 2026. Manufacturing and transmission together represented 34% of all projects in the quarter, up from 18% a year earlier. Their increased share points to broader Chinese participation across power generation, grid infrastructure, and industrial production.

Project Stages and Chinese Actors

Contract signing was the largest milestone category among generation and storage projects, with 36 projects, followed by 32 classified as operational. A further 15 projects were awarded, 12 started construction, and 11 were under construction. Five were recorded as completed, with the remaining two planned or unspecified. This distribution combines a substantial pipeline of newly contracted work with continued progress through construction and delivery.

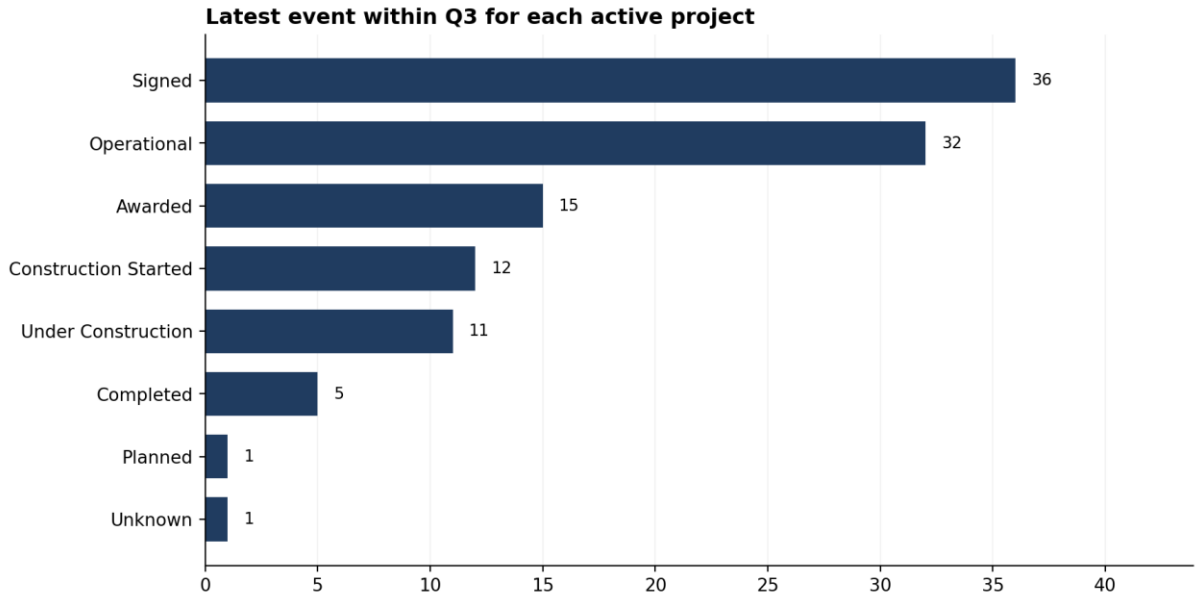


Figure 7. Generation and storage projects by their latest recorded stage in Q3 2026.

PowerChina was involved in ten generation and storage projects. CEEC, Goldwind, Trina Solar and Windey each participated in six, followed by Tianneng Energy with four and China National Building Material Group (CNBM) with three. The leading enterprises include central state-owned engineering groups and specialist wind, solar and battery companies, reflecting the range of capabilities involved in overseas project delivery.

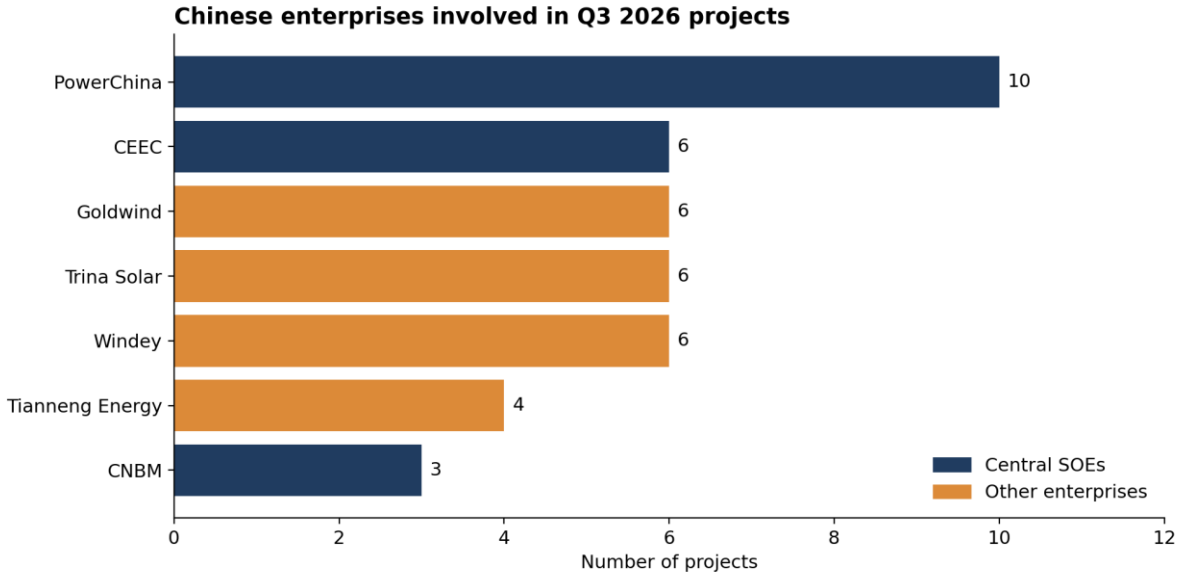


Figure 8. Selected Chinese enterprises by project count, Q3 2026. Colours distinguish central state-owned enterprises from other enterprises. Counts follow recorded enterprise names.

EPC contracting and equipment supply were still the most common participation roles, each accounting for 38 of the 116 recorded project–enterprise–role relationships. Design and

construction services accounted for 13, equity investment for 12, and integrated solutions for 11. Together, EPC contracting and equipment supply represented 66% of these relationships, highlighting the parallel importance of engineering delivery and technology supply.

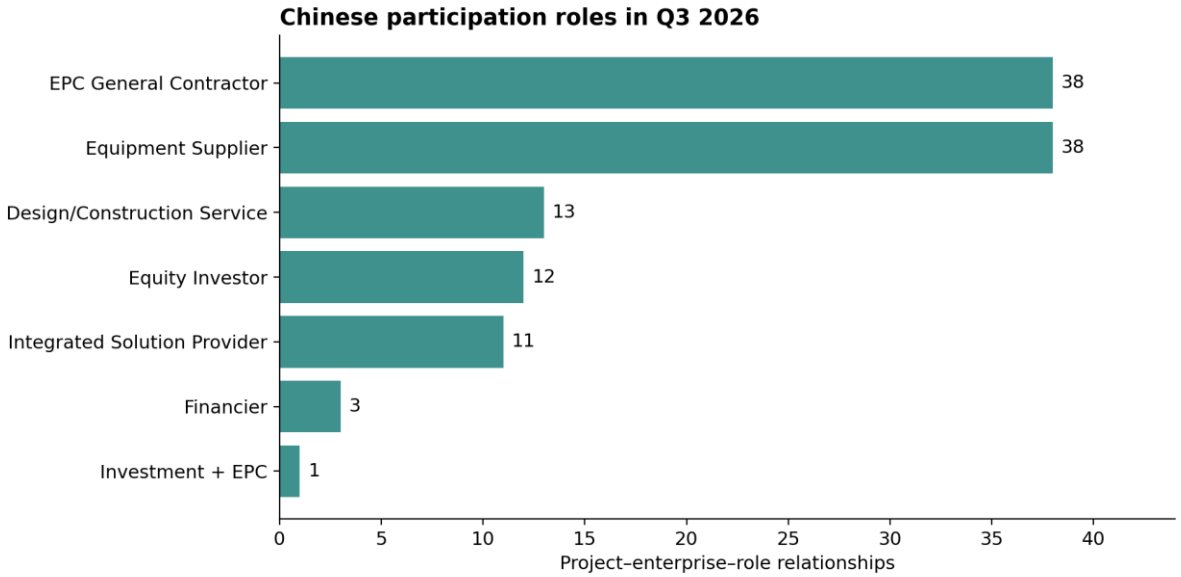


Figure 9. Chinese participation roles in generation and storage projects, Q3 2026. A project may involve several enterprises and roles.

Representative Projects

Abydos II in Egypt



Abydos II battery storage site and adjacent solar arrays in Egypt.
Source: China Energy International Group (CEEC)

Abydos II is a 1 GW solar PV plant paired with a 600 MWh battery energy storage system in Aswan Governorate, Egypt, and among the largest integrated solar-plus-storage facilities under construction in Africa. The project reached a critical delivery milestone: the 600-MWh BESS achieved full-capacity grid connection on 30 June 2026, following the successful reverse power transmission of its 500 kV substation on 8 June [1, 2]. It combines storage integration with an internationally financed, multi-party delivery structure in North Africa.

The project is owned by AMEA Power (UAE, 60%) and Kyuden International (Japan, 40%) through the project company Abydos for Renewable Energy SAE, and sells power to EETC under a 25-year PPA backed by a sovereign guarantee from Egypt's Ministry of Finance. Chinese participation is concentrated at the engineering and equipment layer. A CEEC-led consortium, including China Energy International Group, CEEC Zhejiang Thermal Power Construction, and Southwest Electric Power Design Institute, serves as EPC contractor, with scope covering the PV plant, the 500 kV substation, and BESS integration. JA Solar is the exclusive supplier of 1.25 GW of n-type modules, and GameChange Solar supplies 1.25 GW of trackers to CEEC-ZTPC [3].

Financing is provided by an IFC-led syndicate. The $571.8 million debt package comprises an $83.5 million IFC senior loan and $465.2 million mobilised from CDP, FMO, DEG, BII, the OPEC Fund, and Europe Arab Bank, alongside $23.1 million in concessional blended finance from the Clean Technology Fund and the MENA Private Sector Development Program [4]. The project thus exemplifies the blended-finance model, in which multilateral and bilateral DFIs share risk with commercial and development lenders rather than Chinese policy banks providing the dominant debt tranche. Notably, construction began before financial close,

reflecting sponsor confidence in the project's contractual architecture. The project is part of Egypt's 4 GW Emergency Power Programme and contributes to the country's target of 42% renewable energy by 2030.

Abydos II illustrates that EPC contracting and equipment supply with integrated storage solutions beyond a conventional Solar PV farm is becoming a core Chinese capability in overseas delivery: the 600 MWh BESS is the component that transforms Abydos II from a variable solar plant into a dispatchable night-peak asset.

EVE Energy's Kulim Expansion, Malaysia



EVE Energy's existing manufacturing base in Kulim, Malaysia.
Source: EVE Energy Malaysia

EVE Energy's Kulim base in Kedah, Malaysia, is the company's first overseas mass-production hub and is now being expanded through a third phase that will add 38 GWh of annual energy-storage battery capacity. Phase III broke ground in August 2026, with China Construction Third Engineering Bureau as contractor [5, 6]. The project illustrates a mode of Chinese overseas engagement that differs from mainstream project activities: manufacturing FDI that builds a host-country industrial base, rather than the delivery of a generation asset.

From Phase I to Phase III. EVE's Malaysian investment has progressed in three stages. Phase I, a $422.3 million cylindrical-battery plant, began construction in August 2023 and started production in February 2025, with 680 million units of annual capacity serving power-tool and electric two-wheeler customers. Phase II shifted to energy-storage batteries, with a planned 10–15 GWh of annual capacity and a total investment of up to RMB 8.654 billion. Phase III adds 38 GWh of storage-battery capacity alongside lithium-manganese and lithium-thionyl production lines, bringing Phase II and III combined capacity to 48 GWh per year [5, 7].

The project indicates an emergent trend of allying with Chinese battery manufacturing and Chinese construction capacity in the same overseas project cluster. EVE has committed to working with Malaysian suppliers and building a local battery-manufacturing ecosystem; MIDA has framed the investment within Malaysia's New Industrial Master Plan 2030 and National Energy Transition Roadmap [7, 8].

EVE's Kulim expansion represents a distinct channel of Chinese participation from the EPC- and equipment-supply model. Here, a Chinese manufacturer invests directly in overseas production capacity, a Chinese contractor delivers the facility, and host-country suppliers and

workers are integrated into the industrial chain. It is consistent with our finding that manufacturing projects nearly doubled year on year and that Chinese firms are moving beyond project delivery into batteries, materials, and equipment production.

Conclusion

Q3 2026 showed a broader pattern of Chinese overseas energy activity. Solar remained the largest generation category, wind and storage project numbers increased year on year, and manufacturing and transmission gained a larger share of the portfolio. South-eastern Asia led by project count, while several large developments in Central Asia, Northern Africa and Western Asia shaped the capacity distribution.

The two cases illustrate complementary forms of participation. Abydos II combines Chinese engineering with international developers and development finance to deliver solar and storage infrastructure. EVE's Malaysian expansion links Chinese manufacturing and construction capabilities with building a host-country industrial base. Together, they show how overseas renewable energy engagement is expanding across power supply, storage, and the industries that support their deployment.

References

1. China Energy International Group. (2026, July 1). "Egypt's Abydos Phase II 600MWh BESS Achieves Successful Grid Connection." Available at: https://www.ceecgroup.com/en/news/egypt-s-abydos-phase-ii-600mwh-bess-achieves-successful-grid-connection/1/274
2. AMEA Power. (2025, December 18). "AMEA Power and Partners Advance Landmark Solar and Battery Storage Project to Strengthen Egypt's Energy Security." Available at: https://www.ameapower.com/amea-power-and-partners-advance-landmark-solar-and-battery-storage-project-to-strengthen-egypts-energy-security/
3. JA Solar Technology Co., Ltd. (2025, January 20). "JA Solar Signs 1.25GW Module Deal with CEEC to Supply Africa's Largest PV-Storage Project." PR Newswire. Available at: https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/ja-solar-signs-1-25gw-module-deal-with-ceec-to-supply-africas-largest-pv-storage-project-302355191.html
4. International Finance Corporation (IFC). (2025, December 18). "IFC and AMEA Power Deepen Partnership to Boost Energy Security in Egypt." Available at: https://www.ifc.org/en/pressroom/2025/ifc-and-amea-power-deepen-partnership-to-boost-energy-security-in-egypt
5. Malaysian Investment Development Authority (MIDA). (2024, December 16). "EVE Energy Malaysia Sdn. Bhd. Launches Advanced Battery Manufacturing Facility in Malaysia." Available at: https://www.mida.gov.my/media-release/eve-energy-malaysia-sdn-bhd-launches-advanced-battery-manufacturing-facility-in-malaysia/
6. EVE Energy Co., Ltd. (2025, June 27). "关于孙公司拟在马来西亚投资建设新型储能电池项目的公告" [Announcement on Proposed Investment by a Subsidiary in a New Energy Storage Battery Project in Malaysia] (Announcement No. 2025-088). Shenzhen Stock Exchange. Available at: https://disc.static.szse.cn/download/disc/disk03/finalpage/2025-06-27/fa3c6e05-f4bf-4351-830d-7311e915adb5.PDF

7. EnergyTrend. (2026, August 25). “Over 43GWh: Energy Storage Projects of 5 Companies Including EVE Energy Signed, Started Construction, and Put into Operation.” Available at: https://www.energytrend.com/news/20260825-52018.html
8. The Star. (2026, February 6). “Sapura Industrial subsidiary inks supply agreement with lithium battery manufacturer.” Available at: https://www.thestar.com.my/business/business-news/2026/02/06/sapura-industrial-subsidiary-inks-supply-agreement-with-lithium-battery-manufacturer